

HOUSE BILL 2193

By Hale

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 71,
relative to welfare.

WHEREAS, the Summer Electronic Benefits Transfer (EBT) program, also known as SUN Bucks, in 2024 served over seven hundred thousand (700,000) children in this state; and

WHEREAS, Governor Bill Lee turned down over eighty-four million dollars (\$84,000,000) in 2025 from the Summer EBT program; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 71, Chapter 3, is amended by adding the following as a new part:

71-3-201.

Notwithstanding a law to the contrary, the governor shall not make a decision regarding the option to not enroll this state in or to disenroll this state from the summer electronic benefits transfer program, provided by the food and nutrition service, an agency of the United States department of agriculture, unless the requirement in § 71-3-202 has been met.

71-3-202.

The general assembly may authorize by joint resolution for the governor to not enroll in or to disenroll from the summer electronic benefits transfer program.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.